

I AM AWESOME

Building Self-Esteem & Confidence for Kids (Ages 7-12)

12 Chapters * Stories * Activities * Affirmations * 30-Day Challenge

By Daniel Tesfamariam

I AM AWESOME: Building Self-Esteem & Confidence

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A MESSAGE FOR YOU

Before you turn another page, I want you to know something important: You are enough. Right now. As you are. Not when you get better grades, not when you're more popular, not when you lose or gain weight. RIGHT NOW. This book will help you believe that truth deep in your bones. Self-esteem isn't about thinking you're better than others - it's about knowing you're worthy of love, respect, and happiness. You already are. Let's build on that foundation together.

CHAPTER 1

You Are Unique & That's Great

There are nearly 8 billion people on Earth, and not a SINGLE one is exactly like you. Your combination of thoughts, talents, experiences, humor, and heart is completely one-of-a-kind. That's not just a nice thing to say - it's a scientific fact! Your fingerprints, voice print, and DNA are unique. Even identical twins are different people! Being unique isn't weird - it's your SUPERPOWER.

CHAPTER 1: BUILD YOUR CONFIDENCE

MIRROR EXERCISE:

Look at your thumbprint. No one who has ever lived or ever WILL live has that same print. You are literally irreplaceable.

THE SCIENCE:

Think about this: if everyone were the same, the world would be incredibly boring. Differences make life interesting!

ACTIVITIES:

1. List 10 things that make you uniquely YOU
2. What can you do that nobody else does quite the same way?
3. Draw yourself as a superhero. What's your unique superpower?

AFFIRMATION: "I am unique, valuable, and irreplaceable."

CHAPTER 2

Knowing Your Strengths

Everyone has strengths - things they're naturally good at or have worked hard to develop. Maybe you're creative, kind, funny, athletic, smart, musical, brave, or patient. Knowing your strengths gives you confidence because you focus on what you CAN do instead of what you can't. Strengths aren't just academics - being a good friend is a strength!

CHAPTER 2: BUILD YOUR CONFIDENCE

MIRROR EXERCISE:

Make a list of 20 strengths. Can't think of 20? Ask 3 people who know you well. You'll be surprised what others see in you that you don't notice yourself!

THE SCIENCE:

Your strengths are like tools in a toolbox. Different situations require different tools. The key is knowing which ones you have.

ACTIVITIES:

1. List your top 10 strengths (ask family/friends for help!)
2. How did you develop each strength? Practice? Natural talent? Both?
3. How can you use your strengths to help others this week?

AFFIRMATION: "My strengths make me capable of amazing things."

CHAPTER 3

Dealing with Comparison

Comparing yourself to others is a happiness thief! Social media makes it worse because people only show their best moments. When you compare your behind-the-scenes to someone else's highlight reel, you'll always feel bad. The ONLY fair comparison is you vs. yesterday's you. Are you growing? That's all that matters.

CHAPTER 3: BUILD YOUR CONFIDENCE

MIRROR EXERCISE:

Comparison is like measuring a fish by its ability to climb a tree.

Everyone has different starting points, challenges, and paths. Your journey is YOURS.

THE SCIENCE:

Instead of 'They're better than me,' try 'They're good at that, AND I'm good at other things.'

ACTIVITIES:

1. Identify 3 comparisons you make often. Are they fair?
2. Go 24 hours without comparing yourself to anyone
3. For every person you admire, find something YOU have that they might admire

AFFIRMATION: "I don't need to be like anyone else to be worthy."

CHAPTER 4

Social Media and Self-Image

Social media shows a fake version of reality. Filters, angles, editing, and selective posting mean what you see is NOT real life. Studies show the more time kids spend on social media, the lower their self-esteem. This doesn't mean social media is evil - but you need to use it WISELY. Unfollow accounts that make you feel bad. Follow ones that inspire you.

CHAPTER 4: BUILD YOUR CONFIDENCE

MIRROR EXERCISE:

For every 'perfect' photo you see, remember: they took 47 versions, chose the best one, filtered it, and probably still don't think it's good enough.

THE SCIENCE:

Limit social media time and notice how you FEEL while scrolling. If it makes you feel worse, put it down!

ACTIVITIES:

1. Track: how do you feel BEFORE and AFTER 30 min of social media?
2. Unfollow 5 accounts that make you feel bad about yourself
3. Post something REAL (no filter) and notice: the world doesn't end!

AFFIRMATION: "What I see online is not real life. I am enough offline."

CHAPTER 5

Handling Criticism

Criticism stings, but it doesn't define you. There are two types:

CONSTRUCTIVE (meant to help you improve) and DESTRUCTIVE (meant to hurt).

Learn to tell the difference. Constructive criticism is a GIFT - it helps

you grow. Destructive criticism says more about the critic than about you.

Don't let anyone's words become your inner voice.

CHAPTER 5: BUILD YOUR CONFIDENCE

MIRROR EXERCISE:

Before reacting to criticism, ask: 1) Is this person trying to help me? 2) Is there any truth I can learn from? 3) Would I say this to a friend?

THE SCIENCE:

You are not what others say about you. You are what you repeatedly do and believe about yourself.

ACTIVITIES:

1. Think of criticism that hurt. Was it constructive or destructive?
2. Write a 'criticism filter': questions to ask before taking it personally
3. Practice responding to criticism calmly: 'Thanks for the feedback. I'll think about it.'

AFFIRMATION: "Criticism helps me grow. It does not define me."

CHAPTER 6

Positive Self-Talk: Your Inner Voice

You talk to yourself more than anyone else talks to you - about 60,000 thoughts per day! If that inner voice is constantly negative ('I'm stupid,' 'I can't do anything right,' 'Nobody likes me'), it becomes your reality. But you can CHANGE your inner voice! Replace negative thoughts with realistic, positive ones. It feels fake at first but rewires your brain over time.

CHAPTER 6: BUILD YOUR CONFIDENCE

MIRROR EXERCISE:

Notice negative self-talk and literally say 'STOP.' Then replace it: 'I'm stupid' becomes 'I'm still learning.' 'Nobody likes me' becomes 'The right people appreciate me.'

THE SCIENCE:

Your brain believes what you tell it repeatedly. Choose your words to yourself as carefully as you'd choose words for your best friend.

ACTIVITIES:

1. Write 10 negative thoughts you have, then rewrite each one positively
2. Put positive affirmations on sticky notes around your mirror
3. For one day, treat yourself as kindly as you'd treat your best friend

AFFIRMATION: "I choose kind, encouraging thoughts about myself."

CHAPTER 7

Body Confidence

Your body is AMAZING regardless of its shape or size. It carries you through life, heals when injured, lets you hug people you love, and does billions of things automatically. Body confidence isn't about looking a certain way - it's about appreciating what your body CAN DO rather than only how it looks. Every body is a good body.

CHAPTER 7: BUILD YOUR CONFIDENCE

MIRROR EXERCISE:

Focus on FUNCTION not APPEARANCE: My legs carry me. My arms hug. My brain thinks. My heart beats 100,000 times daily without me thinking about it.
That's miraculous!

THE SCIENCE:

The 'ideal body' has changed every decade in history. It's a social construct, not a health standard.

ACTIVITIES:

1. List 10 amazing things your body does for you every day
2. Stop negative body talk for one full week - notice the difference
3. Move your body for FUN, not punishment. What movement brings you JOY?

AFFIRMATION: "My body is amazing for all it does, not how it looks."

CHAPTER 8

Academic Confidence

You don't have to be perfect in school to be smart! Intelligence has many forms: logical, creative, musical, physical, social, emotional, and more. If you struggle with math, you might excel at writing. If science is hard, maybe you're gifted in art. Academic confidence comes from effort, not just grades. Celebrate PROGRESS, not just perfection.

CHAPTER 8: BUILD YOUR CONFIDENCE

MIRROR EXERCISE:

Einstein failed an entrance exam. Darwin was called 'lazy' by teachers.

Thomas Edison's teacher said he was 'too stupid to learn.' Grades don't measure your worth OR your future success.

THE SCIENCE:

Focus on learning, not just performing. Ask: Am I understanding more today than yesterday? That's success.

ACTIVITIES:

1. Identify your strongest type of intelligence (there are 8 types!)
2. Set a growth goal: 'I will improve at ____ by ____'
3. Ask for help in your weak areas - it's smart, not weak

AFFIRMATION: "My intelligence shows in many different ways."

CHAPTER 9

Social Confidence

Social confidence means feeling comfortable around others - not being the loudest or most popular. It means: being yourself, starting conversations, handling awkward moments, and knowing your worth regardless of others' opinions. Social skills IMPROVE with practice! Every confident person was once nervous too.

CHAPTER 9: BUILD YOUR CONFIDENCE

MIRROR EXERCISE:

Social confidence isn't about impressing everyone. It's about being genuine and knowing that the right people will appreciate the REAL you.

THE SCIENCE:

Tip: Focus on making OTHERS comfortable. When you stop worrying about yourself and help others relax, YOUR nervousness disappears!

ACTIVITIES:

1. Practice making eye contact and smiling at 5 people today
2. Start one conversation with someone you don't know well
3. Remember: most people are too worried about themselves to judge you

AFFIRMATION: "I am worthy of friendship and connection just as I am."

CHAPTER 10

Trying New Things

Fear of failure stops people from trying new things - and that's the BIGGEST failure of all! Everything you're good at now was once something you'd never tried. The first time you rode a bike, you probably fell. The first time you swam, you sank. Growth requires trying things badly at first. Give yourself permission to be a beginner!

CHAPTER 10: BUILD YOUR CONFIDENCE

MIRROR EXERCISE:

The 'comfort zone' is a real thing - but nothing grows there! Think of your comfort zone as a tiny circle. Every new thing you try makes that circle BIGGER.

THE SCIENCE:

No one starts as an expert. Every master was once a disaster. The only way to get good at something is to be willing to be bad at it first.

ACTIVITIES:

1. List 5 things you want to try but are afraid to
2. This week, do ONE thing that scares you a little
3. After trying, rate your fear 1-10 before vs after. It always drops!

AFFIRMATION: "Being a beginner at something is brave, not embarrassing."

CHAPTER 11

Standing Up for Yourself

Self-esteem means knowing you DESERVE respect - from others AND from yourself. Standing up for yourself isn't being mean or aggressive. It's calmly and clearly saying 'That's not okay' when someone crosses a line. You can be kind AND have boundaries. People with healthy self-esteem don't let others treat them badly.

CHAPTER 11: BUILD YOUR CONFIDENCE

MIRROR EXERCISE:

Assertiveness formula: 'I feel [emotion] when you [behavior]. I need [what you want instead].' Practice it until it feels natural.

THE SCIENCE:

You teach people how to treat you. If you accept disrespect, you'll get more of it. If you calmly assert your boundaries, people learn to respect you.

ACTIVITIES:

1. Write 3 boundaries that are important to you
2. Practice saying 'No' without apologizing (in front of a mirror)
3. The next time someone crosses a line, use the assertiveness formula

AFFIRMATION: "I deserve respect, and I set healthy boundaries."

CHAPTER 12

Daily Confidence Builders

Self-esteem isn't built in one day - it's built daily through small, consistent actions. This chapter gives you 30 days of confidence-building activities. Each one takes just 5-10 minutes but compounds over time. Think of it like exercise for your self-worth. Do one every day and watch yourself transform over a month!

CHAPTER 12: BUILD YOUR CONFIDENCE

MIRROR EXERCISE:

Consistency beats intensity. Five minutes daily beats one hour monthly.

Small daily deposits of self-love add up to massive self-esteem over time.

THE SCIENCE:

Self-esteem is not something you find once and keep forever. It's something you practice and maintain, like brushing your teeth. Make it a habit!

ACTIVITIES:

1. Commit to the 30-day challenge starting TODAY
2. Get an accountability partner to do it with you
3. Track how you feel on day 1 vs day 30 - expect amazing changes!

AFFIRMATION: "Every day, I grow stronger and more confident."

30-DAY CONFIDENCE CHALLENGE

Do one each day. Watch your confidence grow!

- Day 1: ☐ Look in the mirror and say 3 nice things about yourself
- Day 2: ☐ Write down 5 things you're proud of accomplishing
- Day 3: ☐ Give someone a genuine compliment
- Day 4: ☐ Try something new (even if small)
- Day 5: ☐ Say 'no' to something you don't want to do
- Day 6: ☐ Write a letter of appreciation to yourself
- Day 7: ☐ Stand in a 'power pose' for 2 minutes
- Day 8: ☐ List 10 things your body can do that you're grateful for
- Day 9: ☐ Start a conversation with someone new
- Day 10: ☐ Celebrate a mistake - what did it teach you?
- Day 11: ☐ Wear something that makes you feel confident
- Day 12: ☐ Help someone without expecting anything back
- Day 13: ☐ Write your strengths on sticky notes around your room
- Day 14: ☐ Do something you're good at and enjoy it fully
- Day 15: ☐ Forgive yourself for something you've been holding onto
- Day 16: ☐ Ask for help with something (it takes strength!)
- Day 17: ☐ Spend 10 minutes doing something just for YOU
- Day 18: ☐ Write down a fear, then do it anyway (if safe)
- Day 19: ☐ Read your affirmations out loud with conviction
- Day 20: ☐ Unfollow one social media account that makes you feel bad
- Day 21: ☐ Make eye contact and smile at 10 people today
- Day 22: ☐ Write 'I am enough' 10 times. Mean it.
- Day 23: ☐ Do 5 minutes of positive visualization (picture success)
- Day 24: ☐ Thank your body for something it did today
- Day 25: ☐ Set one boundary today. Hold it.
- Day 26: ☐ Record yourself saying something kind about you. Play it back.
- Day 27: ☐ Notice one negative thought. Replace it immediately.
- Day 28: ☐ Do something kind for yourself (rest, treat, nature)
- Day 29: ☐ Tell someone you trust something you're insecure about
- Day 30: ☐ Write: 'I am awesome because...' Fill a whole page!

MY AWESOME STRENGTHS LIST

Fill this page with things you're good at - ask friends & family!

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____
16. _____
17. _____
18. _____
19. _____
20. _____

MY COMPLIMENT COLLECTION

Write down every compliment you receive. Read on hard days!

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I AM AWESOME CERTIFICATE

Awarded to:

For completing this entire book!

Date: _____

Author: Daniel Tesfamariam

Date: _____

Today I learned:

How I will use this:

My goal for tomorrow:

Free writing space:

[illegible]

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue or grey ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Date: _____

Today I learned:

How I will use this:

My goal for tomorrow:

Free writing space:

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

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Date. _____

Today I learned:

How I will use this:

My goal for tomorrow:

Free writing space:

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Date: _____

Today I learned:

How I will use this:

My goal for tomorrow:

Free writing space:

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CHALLENGE:

Think of 3 new ideas related to this topic and explain each one.

My Work:

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Self-rating (circle): AMAZING / GOOD / NEEDS MORE WORK

CHALLENGE:

Create a mind map connecting everything you learned.

My Work:

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Self-rating (circle): AMAZING / GOOD / NEEDS MORE WORK

CHALLENGE:

Write a letter explaining this topic to a younger child.

My Work:

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Self-rating (circle): AMAZING / GOOD / NEEDS MORE WORK

CHALLENGE:

Design a poster that teaches the most important concept.

My Work:

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Self-rating (circle): AMAZING / GOOD / NEEDS MORE WORK

CHALLENGE:

List 10 questions you still have about this topic.

My Work:

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Self-rating (circle): AMAZING / GOOD / NEEDS MORE WORK

CHALLENGE:

Draw a comic strip showing what you learned in action.

My Work:

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Self-rating (circle): AMAZING / GOOD / NEEDS MORE WORK

CHALLENGE:

Write 5 ways you can apply this knowledge in real life.

My Work:

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Self-rating (circle): AMAZING / GOOD / NEEDS MORE WORK

CHALLENGE:

Create a quiz for a friend (with answer key!).

My Work:

[illegible]

Self-rating (circle): AMAZING / GOOD / NEEDS MORE WORK

CHALLENGE:

Compare and contrast two concepts from this book.

My Work:

[illegible]

Self-rating (circle): AMAZING / GOOD / NEEDS MORE WORK

CHALLENGE:

Write a short story using ideas from this chapter.

My Work:

[illegible]

Self-rating (circle): AMAZING / GOOD / NEEDS MORE WORK

CREATIVE SPACE: SELF-ESTEEM

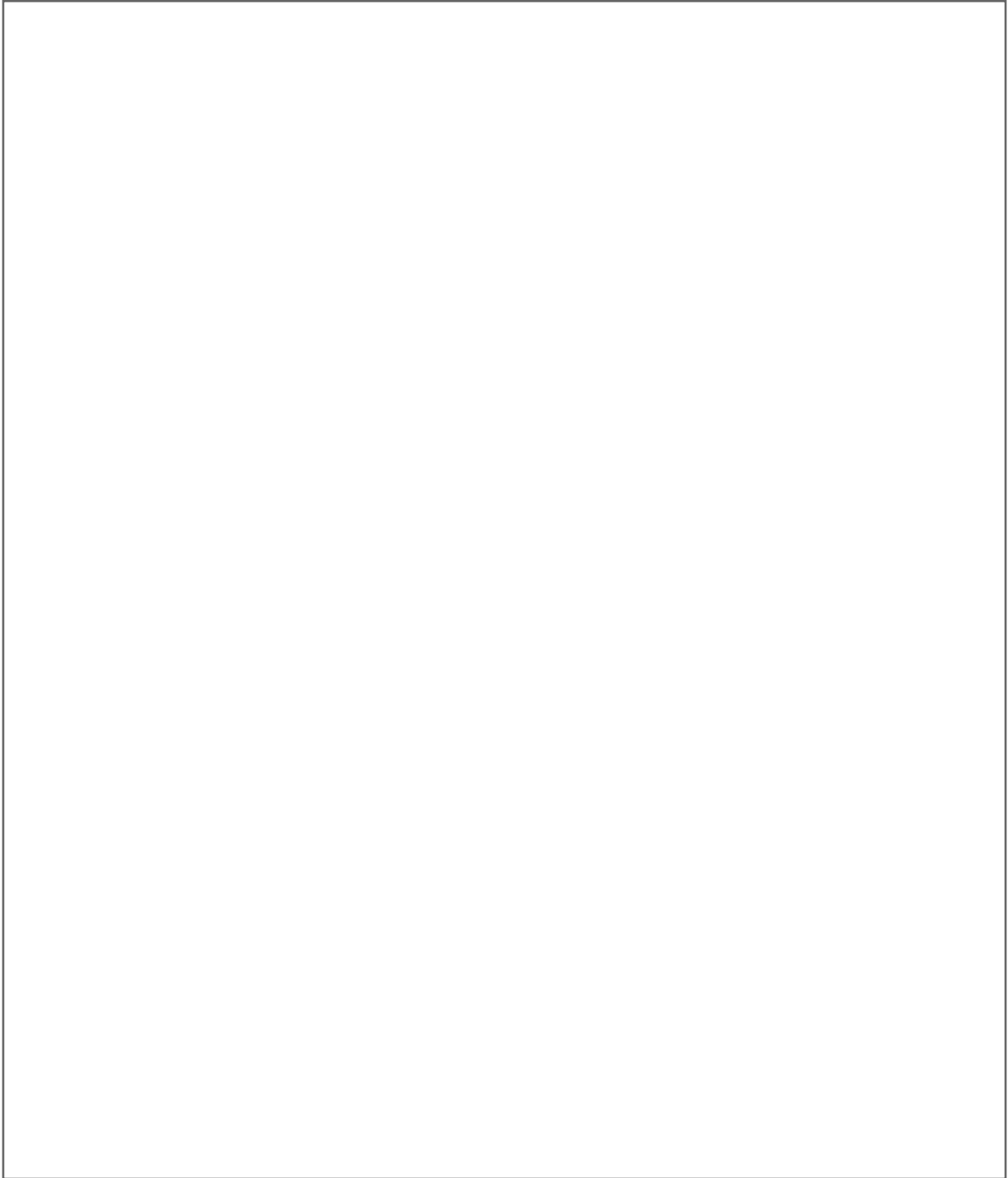
Draw what you learned today

A large, empty rectangular box with a thin black border, occupying the central portion of the page. It is intended for students to draw, write, or brainstorm their thoughts on self-esteem.

Use this space for drawing, writing, or brainstorming!

CREATIVE SPACE: SELF-ESTEEM

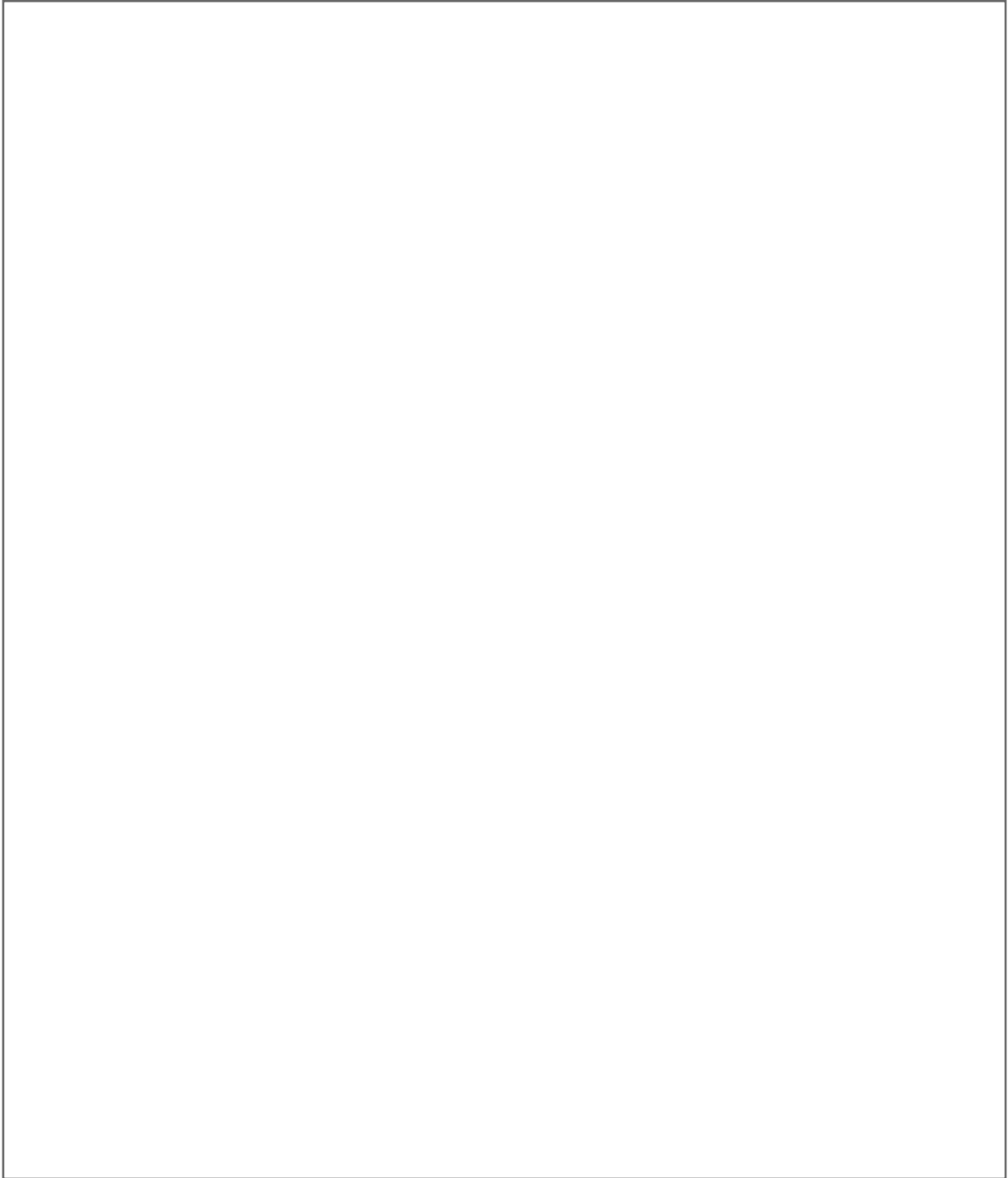
Illustrate your favorite concept

A large, empty rectangular box with a thin black border, intended for drawing, writing, or brainstorming. It occupies the central portion of the page, below the title and instruction, and above the final note.

Use this space for drawing, writing, or brainstorming!

CREATIVE SPACE: SELF-ESTEEM

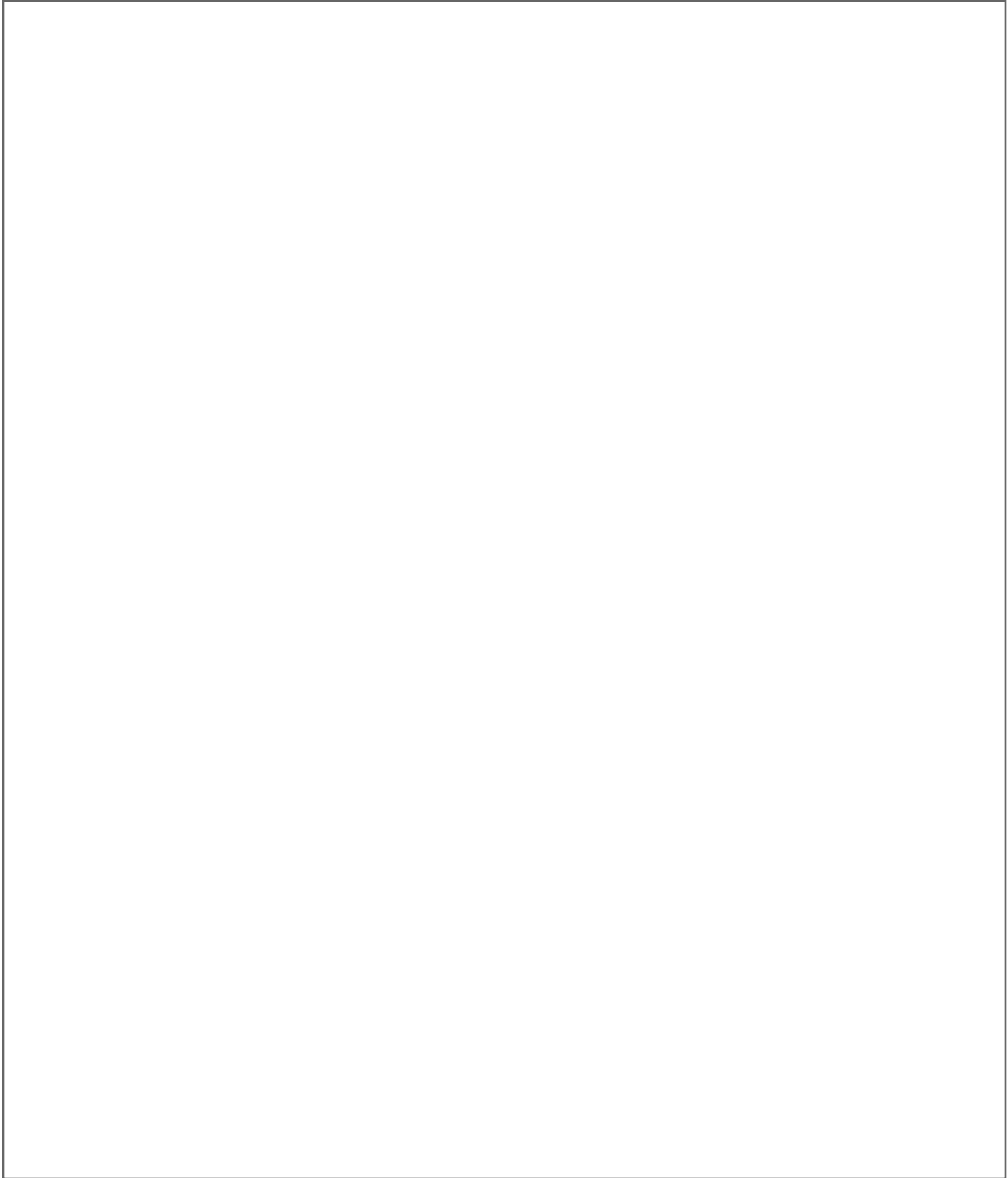
Create a visual summary of this chapter

A large, empty rectangular box with a thin black border, intended for a visual summary, drawing, or brainstorming activity.

Use this space for drawing, writing, or brainstorming!

CREATIVE SPACE: SELF-ESTEEM

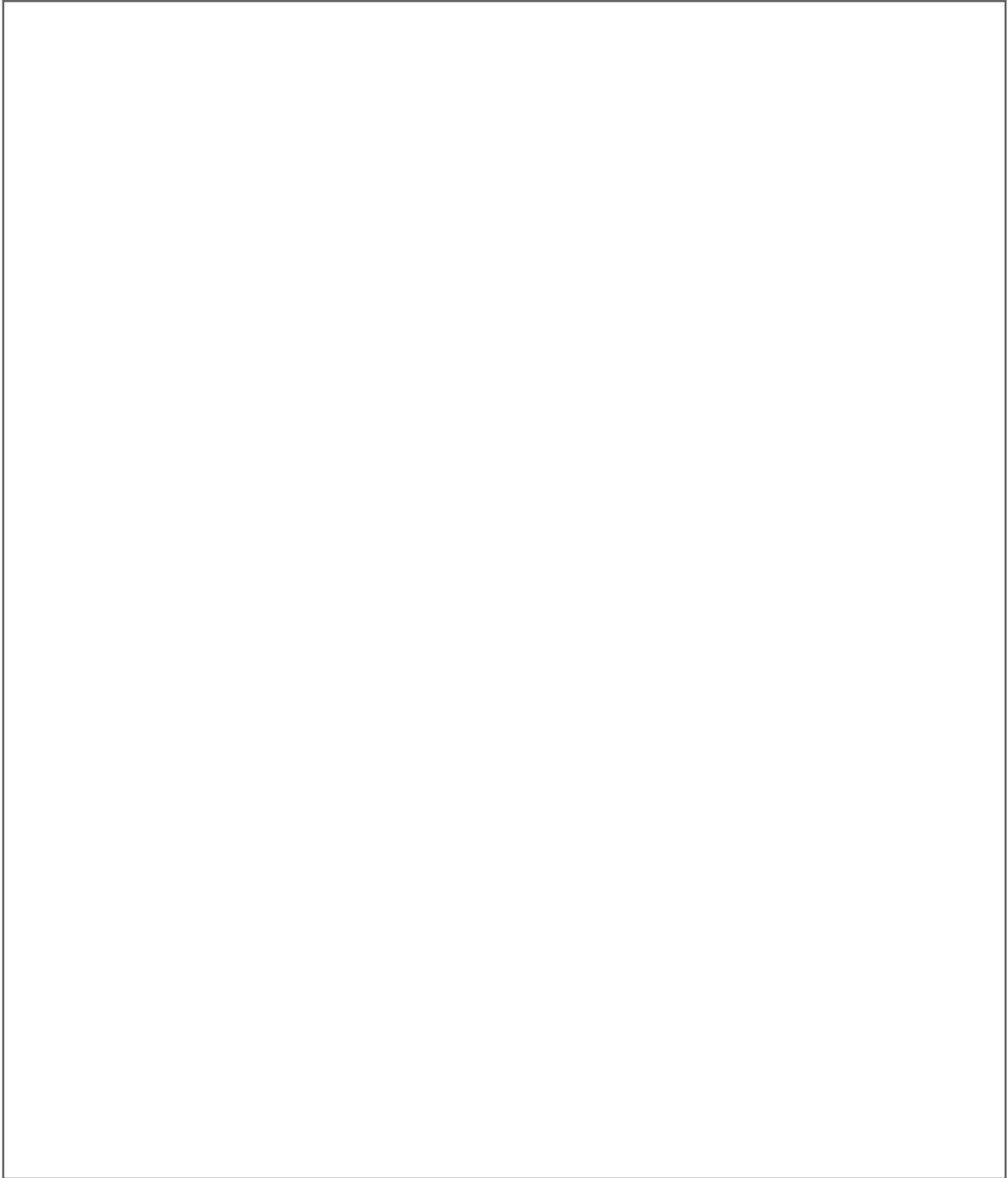
Draw yourself using this knowledge

A large, empty rectangular box with a thin black border, occupying the central portion of the page. It is intended for a student to draw or write within, based on the prompt above it.

Use this space for drawing, writing, or brainstorming!

CREATIVE SPACE: SELF-ESTEEM

Design a symbol that represents this topic

A large, empty rectangular box with a thin black border, intended for a student to draw a symbol or write about self-esteem.

Use this space for drawing, writing, or brainstorming!

CREATIVE SPACE: SELF-ESTEEM

Sketch your goals

A large, empty rectangular box with a thin black border, occupying the central portion of the page. It is intended for a user to sketch their goals, as indicated by the text above it.

Use this space for drawing, writing, or brainstorming!

[illegible]

[illegible]

This image shows a full page of blank, lined paper. It features approximately 20 evenly spaced horizontal grey lines across its entire width, providing a guide for handwriting or typing. The background is a clean, solid white color.

This image shows a full page of blank, lined paper. It features approximately 20 evenly spaced horizontal grey lines across the entire width of the page, providing a guide for writing. The background is a solid off-white color. There are no margins, text, or other markings present.

This image shows a full page of blank, lined paper. It features approximately 20 evenly spaced horizontal grey lines across its entire width, providing a guide for handwriting or typing. The paper itself is a clean, off-white color. There are no margins, text, or other markings present on the page.

This image shows a full page of blank, lined paper. It features approximately 20 evenly spaced horizontal grey lines across its entire width, providing a guide for handwriting or typing. The background is a clean, solid white color.

This image shows a full page of blank, lined paper. It features approximately 20 evenly spaced horizontal grey lines across its entire width, providing a template for writing or drawing. The margins are consistent on all sides.

[illegible]

[illegible]

[illegible]

[illegible]

[illegible]

This image shows a full page of blank, lined paper. It features approximately 20 evenly spaced horizontal grey lines across its entire width, providing a guide for handwriting or typing. The background is a clean, solid white color.

[illegible]